

and continuing with Pagemaker and ASCII encoding, before we began the migration to Scribus.”

The switch to open source, though, required some hardware changes. Some printer and scanner models didn't have official support for Linux so the team had to put in some work to make them compatible. Ranjith Siji adds, “There was a Canon IR 2002 printer and scanner, with unofficial driver images, for which we could make the printer work but not the scanner. The FOSS

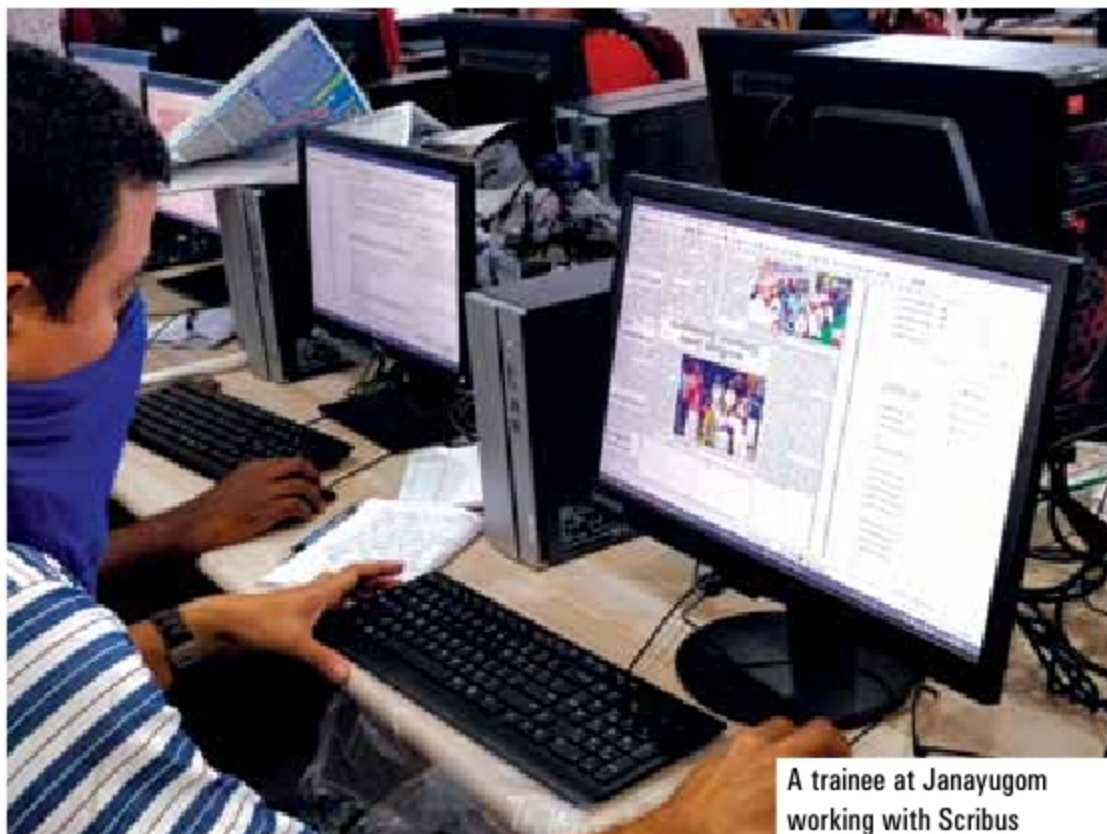
community was helpful by uploading their solutions to these issues and providing good documentation. We hope that these hardware companies will now extend their support to Linux, as the market share of the latter is increasing.”

Scribus is free for everyone

The team at *Janayugam* says that using Scribus has been beneficial financially. To begin with, Scribus is free for everyone, and there is no need to worry about expiring licences and

monthly subscription fees. Though the team faced a few software bugs while implementing Scribus for the newspaper, it had a whole community to reach out to for support. On an average, the community responded to every bug report within 24 hours.

Kannan V.M., software developer and programmer, Alpha Fork Technologies, says, “We should remember that last major update of PageMaker was in 2001, also Adobe stopped supporting PageMaker from



A trainee at Janayugom working with Scribus



Sample newspaper pages designed in Scribus during the training



Alpha Fork developer Ambady Anand S. providing hands-on training to employees of Janayugam